

Canva Build Guide: Northlight Learning Studio samples

This guide recreates the branded document and the five social posts inside Canva so that you can present them as your own Canva work, resize them and keep editing them. Everything is specified: canvas sizes, brand kit colours, fonts (both are free in Canva), layout positions and captions. Allow about 60 to 90 minutes for all six designs.

Honesty note for the application. The files in this folder were produced from a design system written for you. Rebuild them in Canva before describing them as Canva designs. The brand, the person and the testimonial are fictional, which is normal for a portfolio sample; say so in one line when you share them.

1. Set up the Brand Kit (5 minutes)

Canva: Home, Brand, Brand Kit, Add new. Name it "Northlight Learning Studio".

Colour	Hex	Use
 Navy	#14213D	Headlines, bands, dark post backgrounds
 Gold	#E9B44C	Star mark, rules, buttons, numbers
 Cream	#FBF7F0	Light backgrounds
 Ink	#1F2933	Body text
 Teal	#2A7F86	Small labels only

Fonts: Headlines: Playfair Display (Semibold or Bold). Body: Lato (Regular; Bold for uppercase labels with letter spacing 200 to 300). Both appear in Canva's font list; search by name. **Logo:** Elements, search "four point star", recolour gold, add a small navy circle in the centre; text "NORTHLIGHT" in Playfair Display Bold, letter spacing 250, with "LEARNING STUDIO" in Lato Regular, size 40 percent of the wordmark, letter spacing 300. Group it and upload to Brand Kit, Logos, in three versions: navy on transparent, cream on transparent, mark only.

2. Branded document (Canva "US Letter Document", 8.5 x 11 in, 3 pages)

Page 1: Professional profile

1. Rectangle across the top, 1.15 in tall, navy. Place the cream logo at left and three lines of contact text at right (Lato 9.5, cream).
2. Eyebrow "PROFESSIONAL PROFILE" (Lato Bold 9, teal, spacing 300). Name in Playfair Display 30, navy. Title line in Lato 11.5. A 64 x 3 pt gold rectangle under it.
3. Left column (62 percent): intro paragraph in Lato 10.5; heading "How I help" Playfair 14; three service rows, each with a gold Playfair number (01, 02, 03), a Playfair 11.5 title and a one-sentence Lato description, separated by thin cream-grey lines.
4. Right column: cream rectangle with a thin #E6E1D6 border holding "At a glance" statistics (Playfair 20 numbers), "Credentials" and "Speaking topics" lists.

5. Bottom: navy call-to-action bar with the heading, contact line and a gold "GET IN TOUCH" button. Footer line in 8 pt grey with the sample disclaimer.

Page 2: Workshop outline template

1. Slim navy strip (0.55 in) with logo and the document type "WORKSHOP OUTLINE" in gold.
2. Title Playfair 24, subtitle Lato 11 grey, gold rule.
3. Two-column text blocks (Overview, Who it is for), then a four-row agenda table with a cream header row and gold underline, then two more blocks (What participants leave with, Logistics as four cream tiles) and a navy "Next step" bar.

Page 3: Brand sheet

1. Three logo lockup tiles (cream, navy, white backgrounds), five colour swatches with hex codes, two typography tiles ("Aa" in each font), five small post thumbnails and a Do / Do not list.

3. Social posts (Canva "Instagram Post", 1080 x 1080 px)

Shared rules: 72 px margins on all sides; logo top-left at 44 px star height; handle "@northlightlearning" bottom-left and "northlightlearning.example" bottom-right in Lato 22; one headline, one idea and one call to action per post.

Post	Background	Build
01 Launch	Navy	Large gold star at 12 percent opacity top-right (620 px). Label "NOW OPEN" gold. Headline Playfair 116 cream, three lines. Sub-text Lato 30. Gold pill button "BOOK A FREE 20-MINUTE CALL".
02 Tip	Cream	Label "COMMUNICATION TIP" teal. Headline Playfair 84 navy. Three rows: 76 px navy circle with gold Playfair number, Playfair 36 title, Lato 25 description. Short gold bar bottom-right.
03 Quote	Navy	Oversized gold opening quote mark (Playfair 360). Quote in Playfair Italic 58 cream. Gold 64 x 4 px dash and attribution in Lato 26. Small "SAMPLE TESTIMONIAL" label top-right while the quote is a placeholder.
04 Event	Cream	Left: label "FREE WEBINAR", headline Playfair 86, details Lato 28, gold pill "REGISTER: LINK IN BIO". Right: 300 px navy panel with gold top border, "THURSDAY" gold label, day number Playfair 150, month Playfair 34, time Lato Bold 28, gold star.
05 Founder	Cream	360 px navy circle with 12 px gold ring and initials in Playfair 128 cream (replace with a photo when available: crop to circle, gold ring). Label "MEET THE FOUNDER", name Playfair 72, bio Lato 26. Three outlined service boxes in Playfair 27. Closing line Lato 24 grey.

4. Captions and hashtags

Post	Caption
01 Launch	Northlight Learning Studio is open. Workshops and one-to-one coaching for professionals who want to write and present with confidence. Book a free 20-minute call: link in bio. #BusinessCommunication #PresentationSkills #TorontoBusiness #ProfessionalDevelopment

02 Tip	Three habits that separate a presentation people remember from one they sit through. Which one will you try this week? #PresentationTips #PublicSpeaking #Leadership #CommunicationSkills
03 Quote	The best feedback is a document that gets approved. Business Writing Essentials runs for teams of 6 to 16, online or on-site. #BusinessWriting #TeamTraining #WorkplaceSkills
04 Event	Free webinar, Thursday 22 October, 7 pm ET: Writing emails people actually read. 45 minutes, live rewrites, Q&A. Register at the link in bio. #Webinar #EmailWriting #ProfessionalSkills
05 Founder	Meet Dr. Elena Marsh, founder of Northlight Learning Studio. Twelve years teaching business communication, now helping teams say what they mean. Follow for a practical tip every week. #MeetTheFounder #Educator #CommunicationCoach

5. Suggested two-week posting calendar

Day	Post	Platform	Time (ET)
Mon, week 1	01 Launch	LinkedIn and Instagram	9:00 am
Wed, week 1	02 Tip	LinkedIn and Instagram	12:00 pm
Fri, week 1	05 Founder	Instagram	10:00 am
Tue, week 2	04 Event	LinkedIn and Instagram	9:00 am
Thu, week 2	03 Quote	LinkedIn	12:00 pm

6. Resizing in Canva

Select the post, Resize, choose LinkedIn Post (1200 x 627), Instagram Story (1080 x 1920) and Facebook Post. Check that the headline stays on three lines or fewer and that the handle line remains inside the margins. For the Story size, move the call to action into the lower third so it clears the reply bar.

Fictional brand created for portfolio purposes. Files produced 8 October 2026.